5 Food Safety and Quality

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Learning Objectives

- Gain knowledge about the importance of food safety.
- Obtain an in-depth understanding about food quality control.
- Acquire the skill of identifying the adulterants in foodstuffs.

Food safety is a method of handling, preparation, and storage of food in ways that prevent food-borne infections. Food can transmit pathogens which can result in the illness or death of a person consuming it. Bacteria, viruses, mold and fungi are the pathogens responsible for spoilage of food. Food safety is possible when food hygiene is practiced.

According to World Health Organization (WHO) the five key principles of food hygiene are:

- Prevent contamination of food with pathogens spreading from people, pets, and pests.
- Separate raw and cooked foods to prevent contaminating the cooked foods.
- Cook foods for the appropriate length of time and at the appropriate temperature to kill pathogens.
- Store food at the proper temperature.
- Use safe water and safe raw materials.

5.1 Factors Affecting Safety of Food

Factors affecting food safety can be classified broadly into two categories as shown in Fig. 5.1.

Microbial hazards

Human skin, untreated water, pests, raw foods, garbage, debris and dust are the sources of food spoilage by microorganisms

Physical hazards

1. **Food premises and equipments:**
   - Improper and unhygienic handling.
   - Improper working condition of the equipments.
   - Improper sanitation of the premises.
2. **Raw ingredients:**
   - Improper handling of the raw materials.

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